

Surprise package: Jasmine Paolini reached 250 event finals at Jasmin Open Monastir and Palermo Ladies Open, won a 125 tournament at Firenze Ladies Open, and notched excellent wins over No. 4 Elena Rybakina, No. 10 Caroline Garcia, No. 11 Daria Kasatkina, and No. 15 Madison Keys. *AFP*

Palermo Ladies Open, won a 125 tournament at Firenze Ladies Open, and notched up excellent wins over No. 4 Rybakina, No. 10 Caroline Garcia, No. 11 Daria Kasatkina, and No. 15 Madison Keys. In second place, late-blooming (29) Chinese Zhu Lin climbed from No. 84 to No. 37, captured the Thailand Open (250), made the final at the Japan Open (250), and upset No. 6 Maria Sakkari and Garcia.

BEST MEN'S UPSET

"I have watched Daniil play for my entire junior career. I've always dreamed of playing on this court and with these kinds of players. In my best dreams, I've beaten them. So, it's a dream come true," said Thiago Seyboth Wild in his on-court interview after he knocked out No. 2 seed Daniil Medvedev 7-6 (5), 6-7 (6), 2-6, 6-3, 6-4 in a first round shocker at the French Open. The 172nd-ranked qualifier from Brazil outhit Medvedev by 69 winners to 45, including 47-15 on the forehand, belting a forehand winner on match point. Seyboth Wild, who hadn't even played a tour-level main-draw match at all in 2023, instead competing on the lower-level ATP Challenger Tour, called it "the happiest day of my life."

BEST WOMEN'S UPSET

Barbora Krejčíková, searching for the form that won the 2021 French Open, hadn't defeated a Top 10 player in over a year. At the Dubai Open, the versatile No. 30-ranked Czech successively stunned No. 2 Sabalenka, No. 3 Jessica Pegula, and No. 1 Swiatek to become only the third player to vanquish the reigning Top 3 to capture a title. All these upsets deserve consideration, but Krejčíková's 6-4, 6-2 clinic against Swiatek gets the award. Second place goes to Sofia Kenin, who



Bright future: With an improved net game and touch shots complementing his tremendous power, the 22-year-old Jannik Sinner led Italy to the Davis Cup title and reached the final at the Nitto ATP Finals. *AP*